Amazon Fulfillment Center

Workforce Role Analysis

Role relationships, collaboration dependencies & operational insights

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1. Project Overview

This report analyzes the workforce structure of an Amazon Fulfillment Center (FC), examining seven distinct roles across two functional tiers: core fulfillment and management & support. The analysis identifies how roles relate to one another through shared responsibilities, direct collaboration, and operational dependency.

The primary deliverable is an interactive HTML role map and collaboration flowchart built from structured role data, enabling stakeholders to explore each role's responsibilities, key tools, and inter-role connections.

2. Methodology

Data was sourced from a structured workforce table containing the following fields per role:

- Role title and primary responsibility
- Key collaborators (who each role works closely with)
- Operational significance (why the role matters)
- Tools and systems used

Analysis steps included:

- Mapping each role's stated collaborators to identify directional relationships
- Classifying roles into tiers: core fulfillment flow vs. management & support
- Ranking collaboration strength based on frequency and operational dependency
- Designing a visual hierarchy that reflects both authority and workflow

3. Role Summary Table

The table below summarizes the seven roles analyzed, their closest collaborators, and their operational significance.

Role	Works closely with	Why this role matters
Stower	Pickers, Packers	Ensures inventory accuracy and retrieval efficiency
Picker	Stowers, Packers	Directly affects order speed and accuracy

Role	Works closely with	Why this role matters
Packer	Pickers, Shipping Associates	Ensures safe and timely delivery of orders
Learning Ambassador	All floor roles	Improves skill, morale, and operational consistency
Process Assistant	Area Manager, floor teams	Keeps daily workflows efficient and on-target
Area Manager	Process Assistants, all workers	Aligns operations with broader business goals
Robotics Technician	Pickers, Stowers	Keeps automation and robot systems running

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4. Key Findings

4.1 The fulfillment pipeline is the operational backbone

The three core roles — Stower, Picker, and Packer — form a sequential handoff chain that drives every customer order. Each role is directly dependent on the one before it: Stowers must place inventory accurately for Pickers to retrieve it efficiently, and Pickers must pull the correct items for Packers to ship successfully. Errors at any stage compound downstream.

4.2 The Learning Ambassador is the most cross-functional role

Despite not being a management role, the Learning Ambassador is the only position that explicitly supports every other role in the FC. It sits at the intersection of management direction and floor execution, making it a critical — and often underappreciated — hub for operational consistency. In the collaboration flowchart, it was repositioned centrally to reflect this.

4.3 The Robotics Technician provides asymmetric support

The Robotics Technician's support is not evenly distributed: it is concentrated on the Picker and Stower roles, whose tasks are most reliant on automated robot systems (AR Drives, AR Pods). The Packer role, by contrast, relies more on manual and semi-automated equipment. This asymmetry has implications for staffing and contingency planning.

4.4 Management authority flows through a clear two-tier chain

The Area Manager sets zone-level targets and standards; the Process Assistant translates these into floor-level task assignment and team supervision. This two-tier structure keeps strategic oversight separate from day-to-day execution, which is a common pattern in high-throughput logistics environments.

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5. Project Deliverables

- Interactive HTML role map — clickable cards per role with responsibilities, tools, and collaboration details

- Collaboration flowchart — SVG diagram showing reporting hierarchy, fulfillment handoffs, and support relationships with collaboration strength encoded by line weight
- This written analysis report

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6. Skills Demonstrated

This project demonstrates the following competencies relevant to BA/SA/DA roles:

- Business analysis: decomposing a workforce dataset into roles, responsibilities, and relationships
- Systems thinking: identifying dependencies, bottlenecks, and cross-functional touchpoints
- Data visualization: translating structured data into interactive visual deliverables
- Requirements elicitation: iterating on design based on stakeholder feedback
- Technical communication: producing documentation suitable for both technical and non-technical audiences

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